

Innovation and Startup Seed Fund Scheme — Eligibility and Application Guide

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This eligibility and application guide, prepared by Higher Education Department, supports the implementation of Innovation and Startup Seed Fund Scheme. It sets out Seed funding scheme supporting student-led startups and early-stage innovations from higher education institutions. and provides the operational direction needed for consistent, accountable practice.

Purpose of this Guide

This guide supports institutions, officials and beneficiaries in applying the provisions of Innovation and Startup Seed Fund Scheme consistently. It explains eligibility, expected procedures and the supporting arrangements that govern day-to-day practice.

This document accompanies Innovation and Startup Seed Fund Scheme and provides operational detail for Innovation, Startup. Its purpose is to help those responsible for implementation act correctly, consistently and on time.

Scope of Application

The guidance applies to all institutions and stakeholders falling within the scope of Innovation and Startup Seed Fund Scheme. Specific requirements vary according to institutional type, size and stage of implementation.

Except where expressly stated otherwise, the guidance applies uniformly across Higher Education Department, and institutions should treat it as the reference point for day-to-day decisions on Innovation.

Eligibility and Preconditions

Eligible participants should meet the conditions set out in Innovation and Startup Seed Fund Scheme, provide the required information, and comply with the procedural expectations described in this guide.

Implementation Steps

Institutions should first designate accountability, then prepare supporting documentation, brief staff, apply the arrangements and schedule a formal review of the resulting practice.

1. Appoint a lead officer and notify Higher Education Department of the designated contact.
2. Conduct an initial readiness review against Innovation, Startup.
3. Brief governing bodies, staff and relevant stakeholders on the expectations.
4. Apply the arrangements and maintain the required records.
5. Report on a regular cycle and act on review findings.

Roles in Implementation

Clear segregation of duties is encouraged, with institutional leadership providing oversight, the designated office managing administration, and internal controls verifying that practice matches policy.

Operating Steps

Institutions should maintain a written procedure capturing each step of the process, including eligibility checks, documentation, decision-making and appeals, consistent with the provisions of Innovation and Startup Seed Fund Scheme.

Reporting Requirements

A consolidated reporting cycle will allow Higher Education Department to track performance across the sector and to identify emerging issues requiring guidance or intervention.

Conclusion

The success of this scheme rests on shared understanding and consistent application. Higher Education Department stands ready to support institutions in implementing Innovation and looks forward to reviewing collective progress.